ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 65

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Igbo Alphabet

Abịdịị Igbo mbụ m

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 36 Igbo Letters with English Phonetics

A a Ị ị Ụ ụ

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

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My First Igbo Alphabet — Abịdịị Igbo mbụ m
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 65

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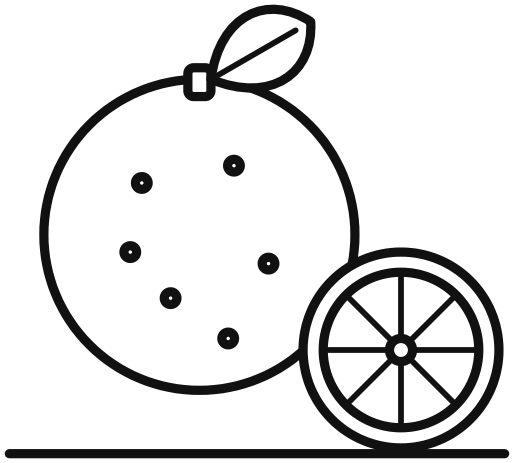
Published by **Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah** (مكتبة كنوز الآخرة),
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust, Bangladesh.
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First edition, 2026.

Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

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A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



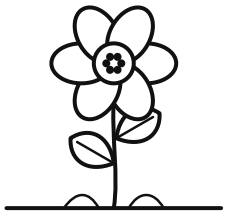
This book belongs to

Akwụkwọ a bụ nke

I started learning Igbo on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 65 is Igbo. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- Igbo is a **tone** language, but everyday Igbo spelling does not mark tones, so the sound guides here have no capitals. Say every syllable evenly and listen to an Igbo speaker for the tune.
- **ee** = i ("see"), **ih** = ị ("sit"), **oh** = o ("go"), **aw** = ọ ("saw"), **oo** = u ("moon") and **u** = ụ ("put").
- **kp** and **gb** are said with the back of the tongue and the lips at the same time.
- **m-** and **n-** before a consonant are a short hum on their own: *m-mee-ree*, *n-kah-tah*.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Igbo name** written in Igbo (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Igbo name · syllables* shows the name Igbo children chant for the letter in the Abịdịị song (B is «bị», M is «mụ») and its syllable row with all eight vowels.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow Standard Igbo (Igbo Izugbe).

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Igbo! Igbo

ee-gboh — the Igbo word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **30 million people** speak Igbo.[3]

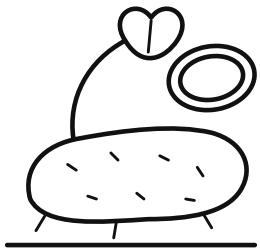
Where?
In south-eastern **Nigeria** — around Enugu, Onitsha, Owerri and Aba — and in Igbo families all over the world.

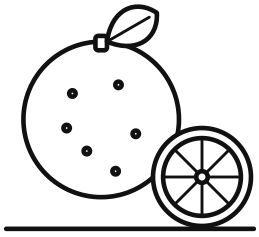
How is it written?
In the **Latin alphabet**, from **left to right**, with dots under **ị ọ ụ** and a dot over **ṅ**. Today's spelling was agreed in 1961 and is called the **Ọnwụ** alphabet.

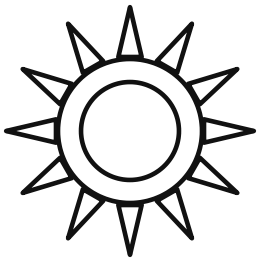
How many letters?
36 letters! Nine of them are pairs that count as one letter: ch, gb, gh, gw, kp, kw, nw, ny and sh.

Listen to the tune
Igbo is a **tone** language: *akwa* can mean egg, cloth, bed or crying — your voice tells which! Learner books mark the tones: *àkwá* (egg), *ákwà* (cloth).

Did you know?
Igbo has **8 vowels** in two teams — **a ị ọ ụ** and **e i o u** — and most words keep to one team, like friends who play together.







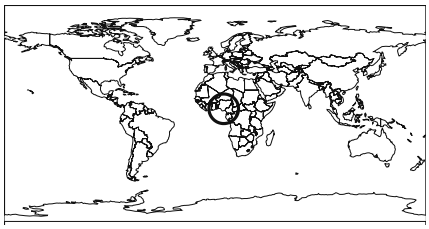
THE WHOLE ALPHABET

The Igbo Alphabet Abịdịị

36 letters — Abịdịị Igbo

Aa *ah*	**Bb** *bih*	**Ch ch** *chih*	**Dd** *dih*	**Ee** *eh*	**Ff** *fu*
Gg *gih*	**Gb gb** *gbih*	**Gh gh** *ghih*	**Gw gw** *gwu*	**Hh** *hih*	**Ii** *ee*
Ị ị *ih*	**Jj** *jih*	**Kk** *kih*	**Kp kp** *kpih*	**Kw kw** *kwu*	**Ll** *lih*
Mm *mu*	**Nn** *nu*	**Ṅ ṅ** *ngu*	**Nw nw** *nwu*	**Ny ny** *nyih*	**Oo** *oh*
Ọ ọ *aw*	**Pp** *pih*	**Rr** *rih*	**Ss** *sih*	**Sh sh** *shih*	**Tt** *tih*
Uu *oo*	**Ụ ụ** *u*	**Vv** *vih*	**Ww** *wu*	**Yy** *yih*	**Zz** *zih*

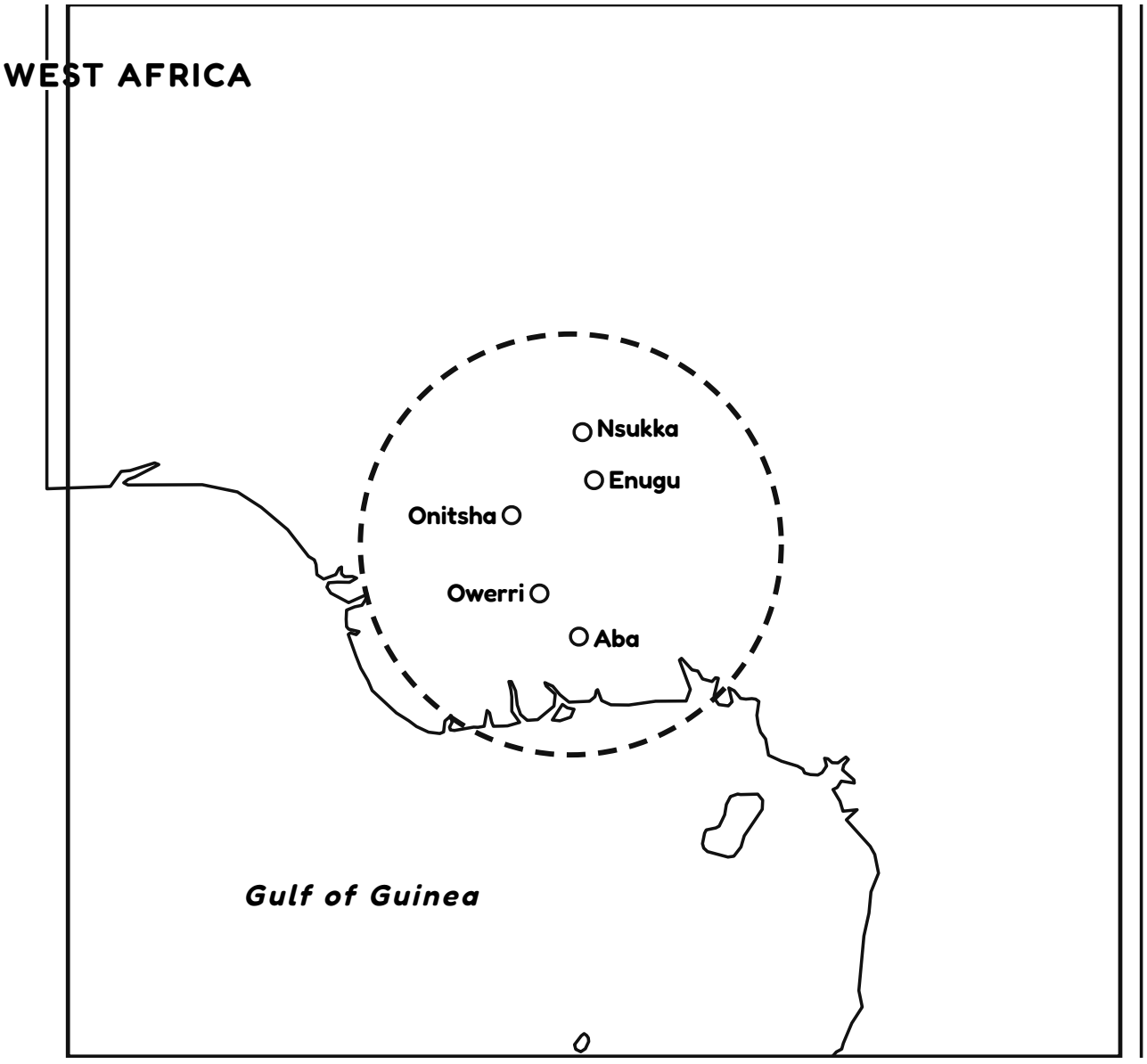
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows Igboland, in West Africa, on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Igbo spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the ocean **blue**. **Find it:** Igbo is spoken in Enugu, Nsukka, Onitsha, Owerri, Aba and many other towns. The dashed line shows where most Igbo speakers live.

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THE LETTERS

The Letters Abịdịị Igbo

ah-bih-dih-ih ee-gboh — “the Igbo A-B-D”

The Igbo alphabet, the **Abịdịị**, has **36 letters**. Nine of them are written with two letters: **ch gb gh gw kp kw nw ny sh**. There is no C, Q or X.

Eight vowels in two teams
a ị ọ ụ and **e i o u**. A dot under a vowel makes it more open: **i** “see”, **ị** “sit”; **o** “go”, **ọ** “saw”; **u** “moon”, **ụ** “put”. Most words use vowels from one team: *ụlọ*, *ite*.

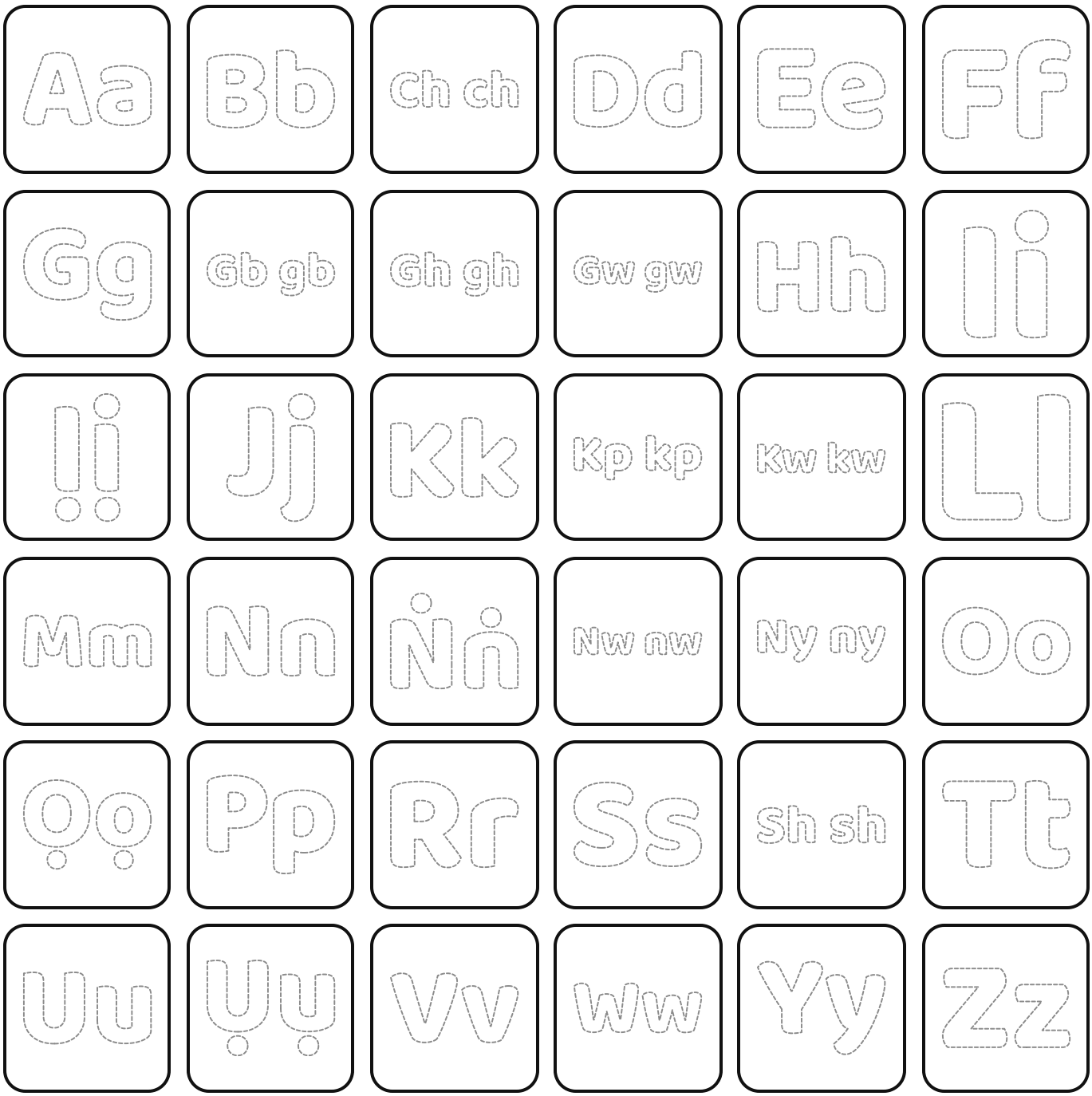
Ṅ with a dot on top
ṅ says “ng” as in “sing”. Look for it in *aṅụ* (bee).

Big and small
Each page shows the **capital letter** and the **small letter** side by side: **Ụụ**. Color both!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letters Abịdịị Igbo

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



Aa

NAME · AHA

a

ah

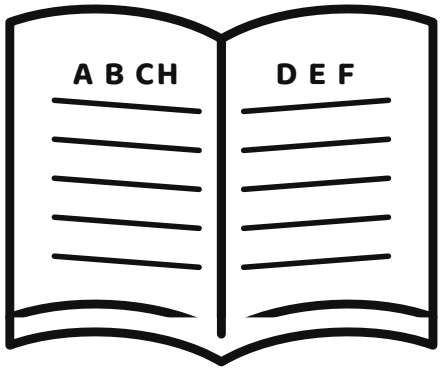
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘a’ as in “father”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

A a — «a»

ba · da · ka · ma · na



AA IS FOR

akwụkwọ

ah-kwu-kwaw

book

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Aa Aa Aa Aa

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Bb

NAME · AHA

bị

bih

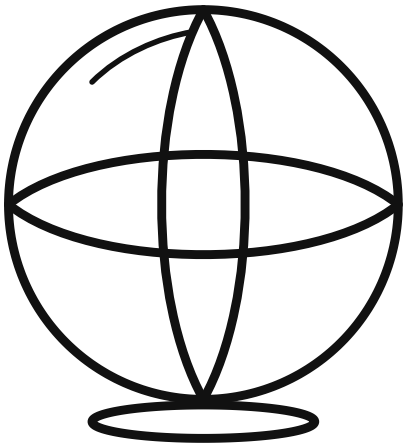
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

B b — «bị»

ba · be · bi · bị · bo · bọ · bu · bụ



BB IS FOR

bọọlụ

baw-aw-lu

ball

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Bb Bb Bb Bb

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Ch ch

NAME · AHA

chị

chih

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ as in “church”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

Ch ch — «chị»

cha · che · chi · chị · cho · chọ · chu · chụ

Ch is written with two letters but counts as **one** Igbo letter.



CH CH IS FOR

nche anwụ

n-cheh ahn-wu

umbrella (“sun shield”)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Ch ch Ch ch Ch ch Ch ch

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Dd

NAME · AHA

dị

dih

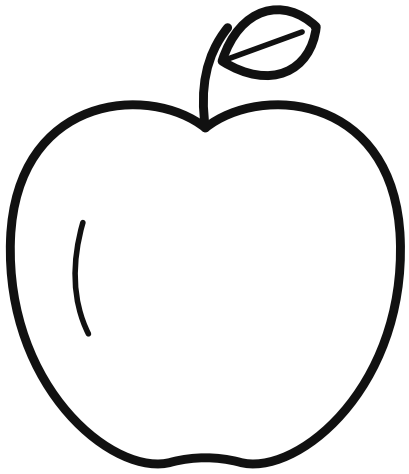
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “door”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

D d — «dị»

da · de · di · dị · do · dọ · du · dụ



DD IS FOR

ụdara

u-dah-rah

African star apple (a sweet fruit)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Dd Dd Dd Dd

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Ee

NAME · AHA

e

eh

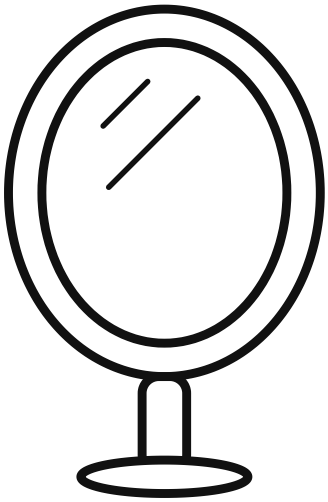
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘e’ as in “bed”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

E e — «e»

be · de · ke · me · ne



EE IS FOR

enyo

eh-nyoh

mirror

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Ee Ee Ee Ee

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Ff

NAME · AHA

fụ

fu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

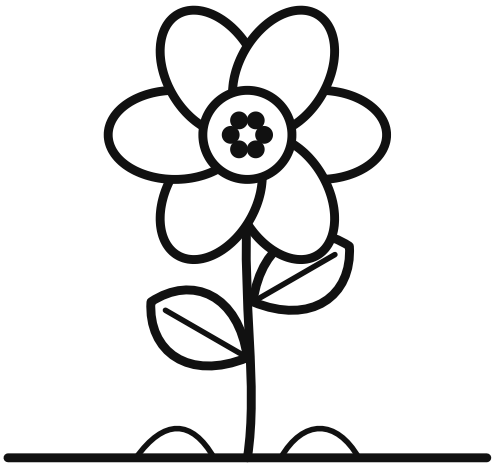
‘f’ as in “fan”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

F f — «fụ»

fa · fe · fi · fị · fo · fọ · fu · fụ

Few Igbo words start with F. Find it inside *ifuru*!



FF IS FOR

ifuru

ee-foo-roo

flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Ff Ff Ff Ff

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Gg

NAME · AHA

gị

gih

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

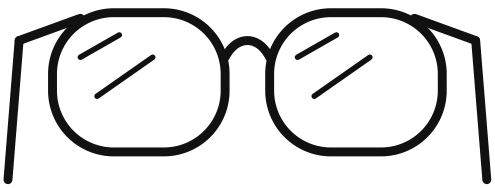
‘g’ as in “go” (always hard)

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

G g — «gị»

ga · ge · gi · gị · go · gọ · gu · gụ

GG IS FOR



ugegbe anya

oo-geh-gbeh ah-nyah

glasses (“eye mirror”)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Gg Gg Gg Gg

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Gb gb

NAME · AHA

gbị

gbih

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

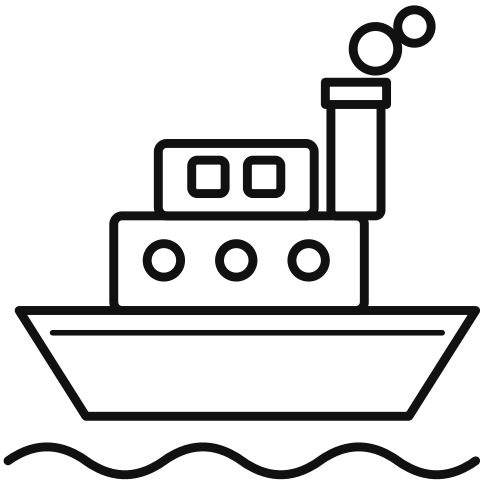
‘g’ and ‘b’ said **together**, at the same time

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

Gb gb — «gbị»

gba · gbe · gbi · gbị · gbo · gbọ · gbu · gbụ

Gb is written with two letters but counts as **one** Igbo letter.



GB GB IS FOR

ụgbọ mmiri

u-gbaw m-mee-ree

ship (“water vehicle”)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Gb gb Gb gb Gb gb Gb gb

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Gh gh

NAME · AHA

ghị

ghih

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

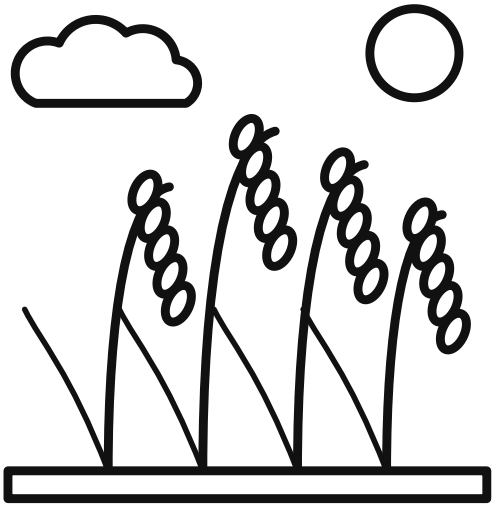
a soft gargled ‘g’ from the back of the throat, like Arabic غ

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

Gh gh — «ghị»

gha · ghe · ghi · ghị · gho · ghọ · ghu · ghụ

Gh is written with two letters but counts as **one** Igbo letter.



GH GH IS FOR

ịgha mkpụrụ

ih-ghah m-kpu-ru

sowing seeds

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Gh gh Gh gh Gh gh Gh gh

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Gw gw

NAME · AHA

gwụ

gwu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

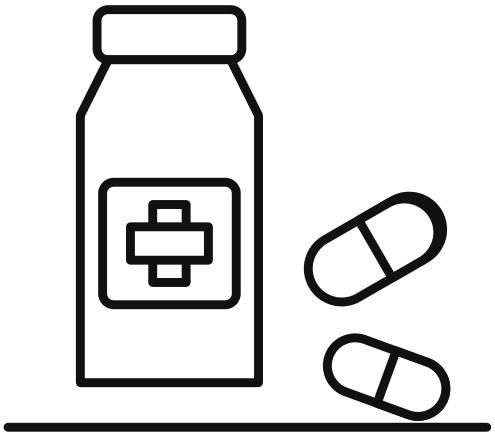
‘gw’ as in “Gwen”, with round lips

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

Gw gw — «gwụ»

gwa · gwe · gwi · gwị · gwo · gwọ · gwu · gwụ

Gw is written with two letters but counts as **one** Igbo letter.



GW GW **IS FOR**

ọgwụ

aw-gwu

medicine

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Gw gw Gw gw Gw gw Gw gw

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Hh

NAME · AHA

hị

hih

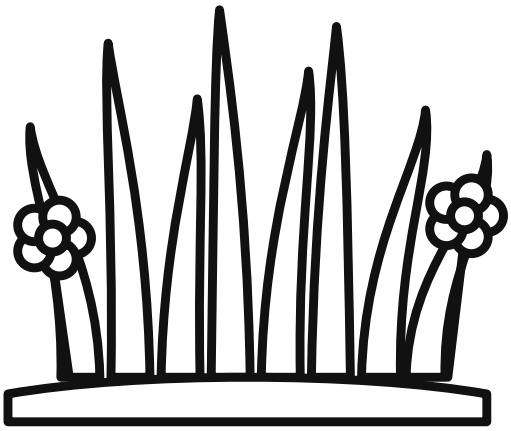
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

H h — «hị»

ha · he · hi · hị · ho · họ · hu · hụ



HH IS FOR

ahịhịa

ah-hih-hih-ah

grass

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Hh Hh Hh Hh

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Ii

NAME · AHA

i

ee

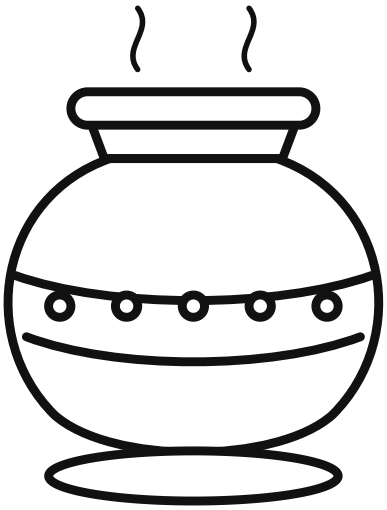
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ee’ as in “see”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

| i — «i»

bi · di · ki · mi · ni



II IS FOR

ite

ee-teh

cooking pot

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Ii Ii Ii Ii

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NAME · AHA

ih

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

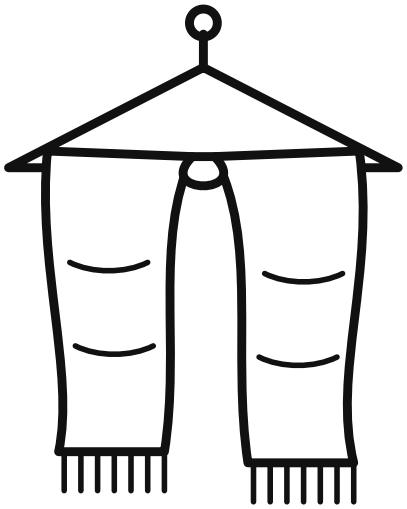
‘i’ as in “sit” — the dot makes it open

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

ị ị — «ị»

bị · dị · kị · mị · nị

i = see · ị = sit



ị IS FOR

ịchafụ

ih-chah-fu

headscarf

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

ị ị ị ị

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Jj

NAME · AHA

jị

jih

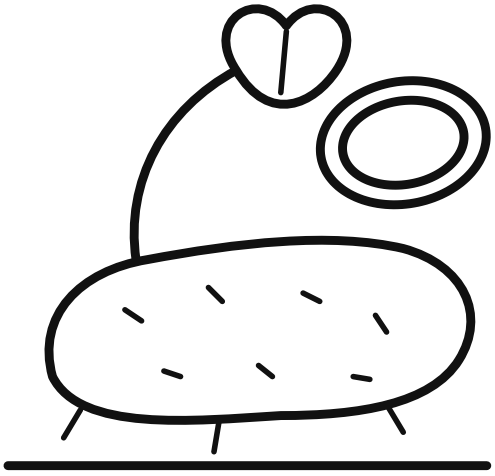
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘j’ as in “jam”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

Ꭻ j — «jị»

ja · je · ji · jị · jo · jọ · ju · jụ



JJ IS FOR

ji

jee

yam

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Jj Jj Jj Jj

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Kk

NAME · AHA

kị

kih

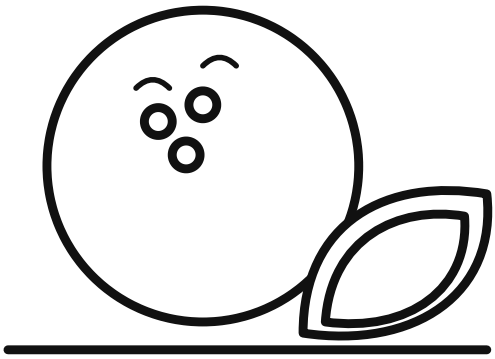
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

K k — «kị»

ka · ke · ki · kị · ko · kọ · ku · kụ



KK IS FOR

akị oyibo

ah-kih oh-yee-boh

coconut

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Kk Kk Kk Kk

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Kp kp

NAME · AHA

kpị

kpih

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

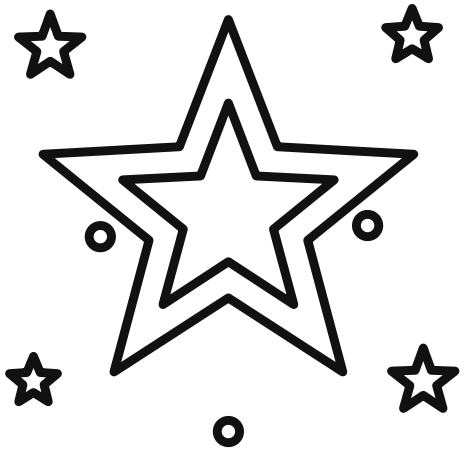
‘k’ and ‘p’ said **together**, at the same time

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

Kp kp — «kpị»

kpa · kpe · kpi · kpị · kpo · kpọ · kpu · kpụ

Kp is written with two letters but counts as **one** Igbo letter.



KP KP IS FOR

kpakpando

kpah-kpahn-doh

star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Kp kp Kp kp Kp kp Kp kp

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Kw kw

NAME · AHA

kwụ

kwu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

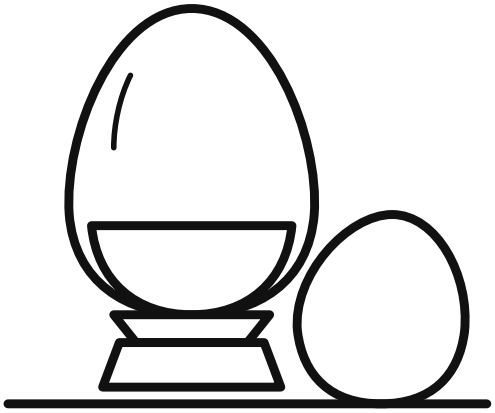
‘kw’ as in “quick”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

Kw kw — «kwụ»

kwa · kwe · kwi · kwị · kwo · kwọ · kwu · kwụ

Kw is written with two letters but counts as **one** Igbo letter.



KW KW **IS FOR**

akwa

ah-kwah

egg

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Kw kw Kw kw Kw kw Kw kw

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Ll

NAME · AHA

ḷị

lih

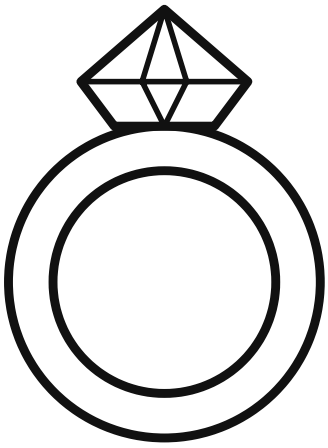
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘l’ as in “lamp”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

L l — «ḷị»

la · le · li · ḷị · lo · ọ · lu · ụ



LL IS FOR

ọla

aw-lah

ring, jewelry

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Ll Ll Ll Ll Ll

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Mm

NAME · AHA

mụ

mu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

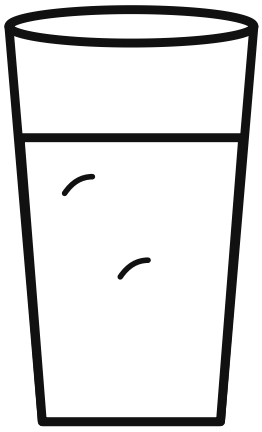
‘m’ as in “moon”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

M m — «mụ»

ma · me · mi · mị · mo · mọ · mu · mụ

M can be a whole syllable on its own: *m-mi-ri*.



MM IS FOR

mmiri

m-mee-ree

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Mm Mm Mm Mm

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Nn

NAME · AHA

nụ

nu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

N n — «nụ»

na · ne · ni · nị · no · nọ · nu · nụ



NN IS FOR

nkata

n-kah-tah

basket

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Nn Nn Nn Nn

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Ṅṅ

NAME · AHA

ṅụ

ngu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

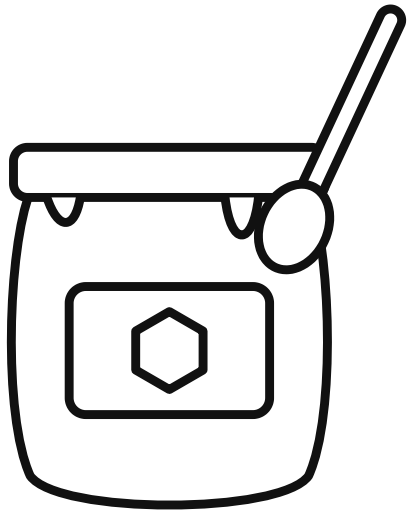
‘ng’ as in “sing”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

Ṅ ṅ — «ṅụ»

ṅa · ṅe · ṅi · ṅị · ṅo · ṅọ · ṅu · ṅụ

n = **n**et · ṅ = si**ng**



ṄṄ IS FOR

mmanụ aṅụ

m-mah-nu ah-ngu

honey (“bee oil”)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Ṅṅ Ṅṅ Ṅṅ Ṅṅ

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Nw nw

NAME · AHA

nwụ

nwu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ and ‘w’ together, with round lips

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

Nw nw — «nwụ»

nwa · nwe · nwi · nwị · nwo · nwọ · nwu · nwụ

Nw is written with two letters but counts as **one** Igbo letter.



NW NW **IS FOR**

ọnwa

aw-nwah

moon, month

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Nw nw Nw nw Nw nw Nw nw

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Ny ny

NAME · AHA

nyị

nyih

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

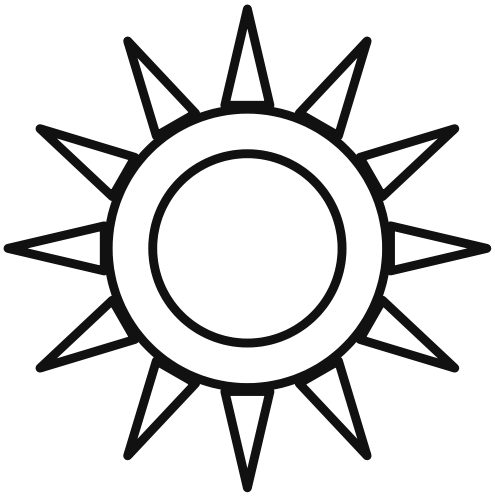
‘ny’ as in “canyon”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

Ny ny — «nyị»

nya · nye · nyi · nyị · nyo · nọ · nyu · nụ

Ny is written with two letters but counts as **one** Igbo letter.



NY NY IS FOR

anyanwụ

ah-nyahn-wu

sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Ny ny Ny ny Ny ny Ny ny

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Oo

NAME · AHA

o

oh

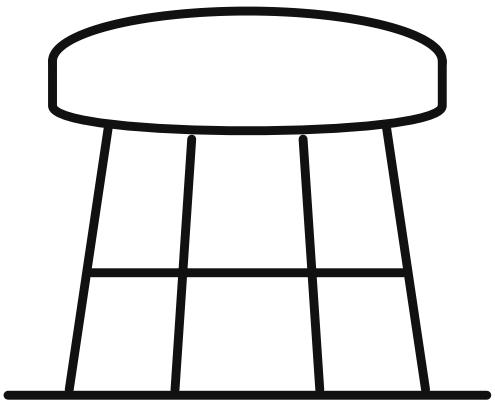
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘o’ as in “go”, short and pure

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

O o — «o»

bo · do · ko · mo · no



OO IS FOR

oche

oh-cheh

chair, seat

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Oo Oo Oo Oo

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Ọọ

NAME · AHA

ọ

aw

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

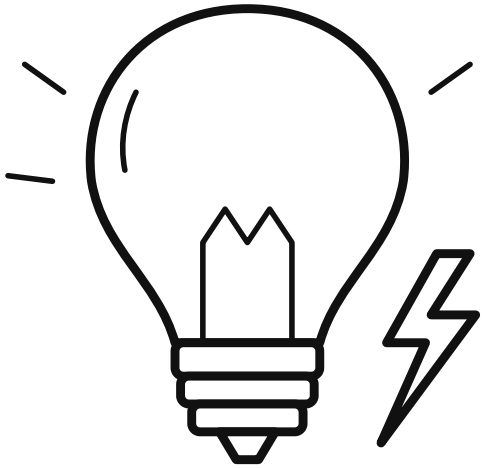
‘aw’ as in “saw” — the dot makes it open

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

Ọ ọ — «ọ»

bọ · dọ · kọ · mọ · nọ

o = g**o** · ọ = s**aw**



ỌỌ IS FOR

ọkụ

aw-ku

fire, light

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Oo Oo Oo Oo

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Pp

NAME · AHA

pị

pih

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

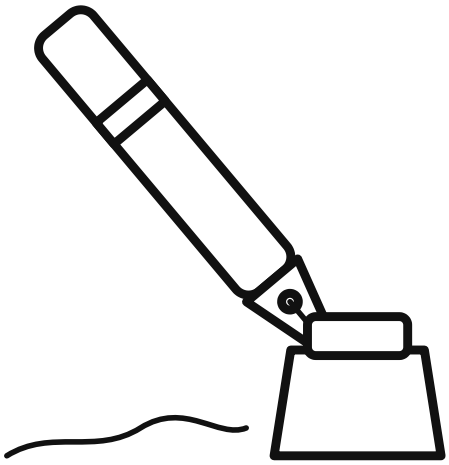
‘p’ as in “pen”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

P p — «pị»

pa · pe · pi · pị · po · pọ · pu · pụ

P mostly starts words that came from other languages, like *pensụl*.



PP IS FOR

pensụl

pen-sul

pencil

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Pp Pp Pp Pp

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Rr

NAME · AHA

rị

rih

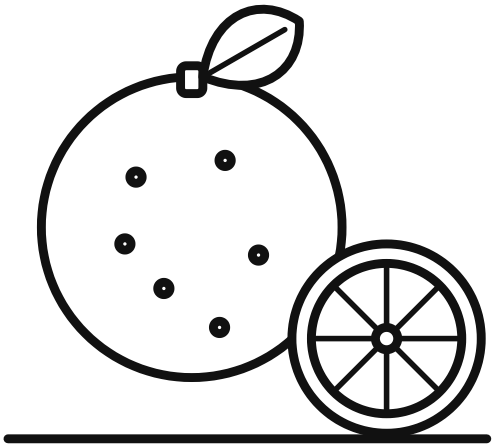
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a quick tapped ‘r’

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

R r — «rị»

ra · re · ri · rị · ro · rọ · ru · rụ



RR IS FOR

oroma

oh-roh-mah

orange

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Rr Rr Rr Rr

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Ss

NAME · AHA

sị

sih

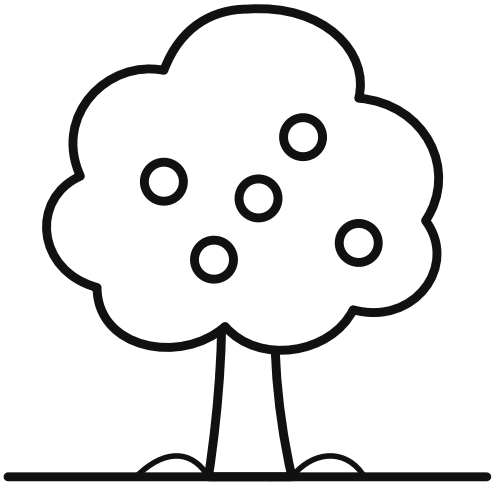
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

S s — «sị»

sa · se · si · sị · so · sọ · su · sụ



SS IS FOR

osisi

oh-see-see

tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Ss Ss Ss Ss

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Sh sh

NAME · AHA

shị

shih

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

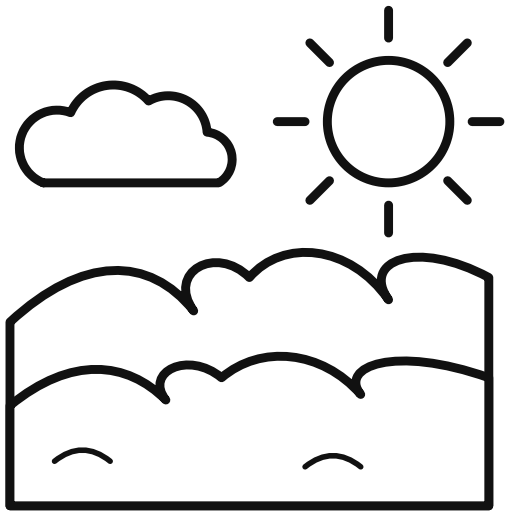
‘sh’ as in “ship”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

Sh sh — «shị»

sha · she · shi · shị · sho · shọ · shu · shụ

Sh is written with two letters but counts as **one** Igbo letter.



SH SH IS FOR

ọshịmịrị

aw-shih-mih-rih

sea, ocean

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Sh sh Sh sh Sh sh Sh sh

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Tt

NAME · AHA

ṭị

tih

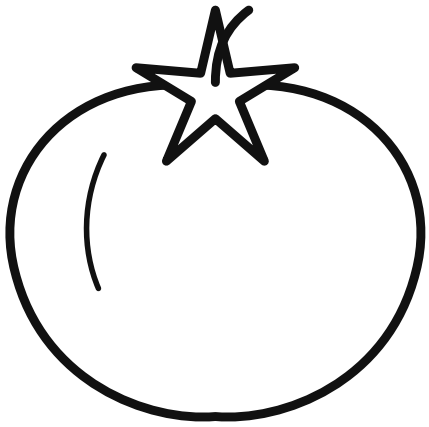
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “tap”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

T t — «ṭị»

ta · te · ti · ṭị · to · ọ · tu · ụ



TT IS FOR

tomato

toh-mah-toh

tomato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Tt Tt Tt Tt

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Uu

NAME · AHA

u

oo

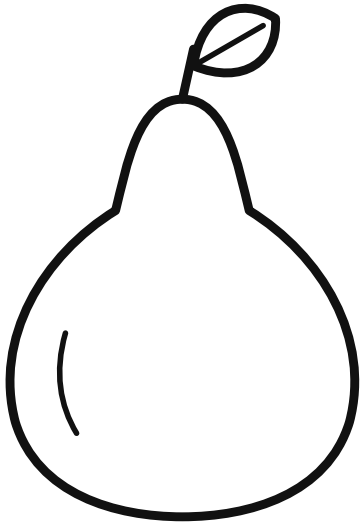
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘oo’ as in “moon”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

U u — «u»

bu · du · ku · mu · nu



UU IS FOR

ube

oo-beh

African pear (a soft purple fruit)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Uu Uu Uu Uu

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Ụ ụ

NAME · AHA

ụ

u

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

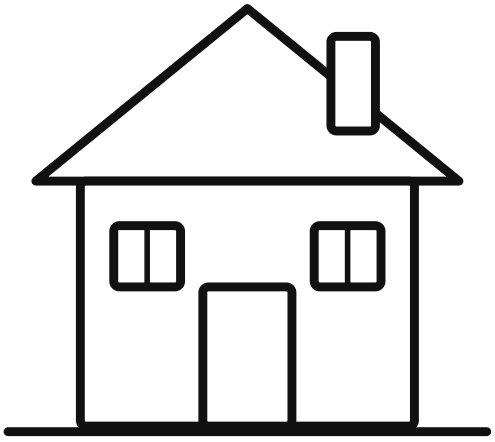
‘u’ as in “put” — the dot makes it open

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

Ụ ụ — «ụ»

bụ · dụ · kụ · mụ · nụ

u = m**oo**n · ụ = p**u**t



ỤỤ IS FOR

ụlọ

u-law

house

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Ụ ụ Ụ ụ Ụ ụ Ụ ụ

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Vv

NAME · AHA

vị

vih

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

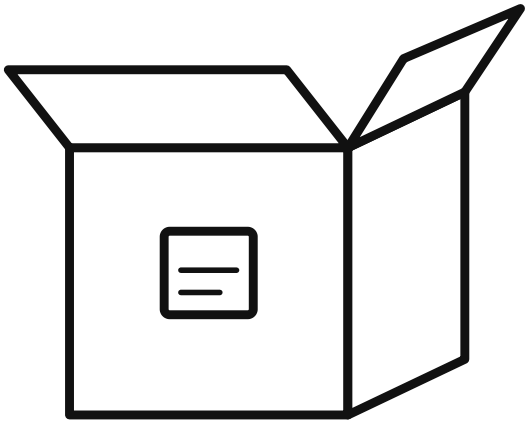
‘v’ as in “van”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

V v — «vị»

va · ve · vi · vị · vo · vọ · vu · vụ

V is a rare letter in Igbo. Find it inside *ivu*!



VV IS FOR

ivu

ee-voo

a load to carry

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Vv Vv Vv Vv

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Ww

NAME · AHA

wụ

wu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

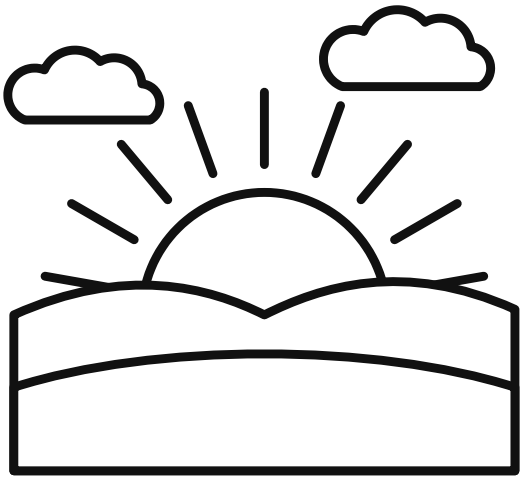
‘w’ as in “water”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

W w — «wụ»

wa · we · wi · wị · wo · wọ · wu · wụ

WW IS FOR



ọwụwa

anyanwụ

aw-wu-wah ah-nyahn-wu

sunrise

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Ww Ww Ww Ww

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Yy

NAME · AHA

yị

yih

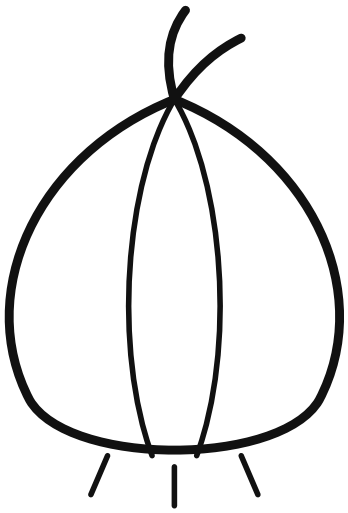
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

Y y — «yị»

ya · ye · yi · yị · yo · yọ · yu · yụ



YY IS FOR

yabasị

yah-bah-sih

onion

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

Yy Yy Yy Yy

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Zz

NAME · AHA

zị

zih

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘z’ as in “zoo”

IGBO NAME · SYLLABLES

Z z — «zị»

za · ze · zi · zị · zo · zọ · zu · zụ



ZZ IS FOR

mmiri ozuzo

m-mee-ree oh-zoo-zoh

rain (“falling water”)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · DEE YA

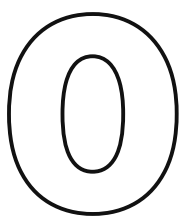
Zz Zz Zz Zz

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BONUS

Igbo numbers ọnụọgụgụ *(aw-nu-aw-gu-gu)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Igbo: *eh-foo, oh-too, ah-bu-aw, ah-taw...*

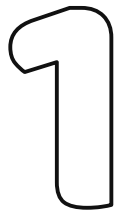


0

efu

eh-foo

zero



1

otu

oh-too

one



2

abụọ

ah-bu-aw

two

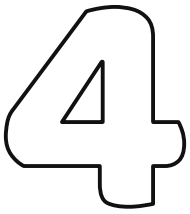


3

atọ

ah-taw

three



4

anọ

ah-naw

four



5

ise

ee-seh

five



6

isii

ee-see-ee

six

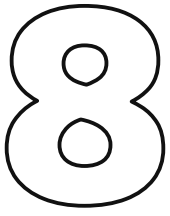


7

asaa

ah-sah-ah

seven

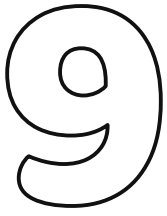


8

asatọ

ah-sah-taw

eight



9

itoolu

ee-toh-oh-loo

nine

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LET'S TALK

My first Igbo words Okwu mbụ

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

Assalamu alaikum

as-sah-lah-moo ah-lay-koom
Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)

Wa alaikum salaam

wah ah-lay-koom sah-lahm
And peace be upon you (the reply)

Ndewo!

n-deh-woh
Hello!

Aha m bụ ...

ah-hah m bu ...
My name is ...

Daalụ

dah-ah-lu
Thank you

Jazakallahu khairan

jah-zah-kah-lah-hoo khai-rahn
May Allah reward you with good

nne · nna

n-neh · n-nah
Mother · Father

nwanne nwoke · nwanne nwaanyị

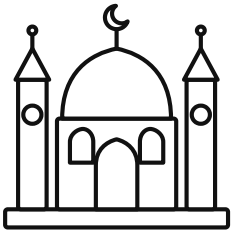
nwahn-neh nwoh-keh · nwahn-neh nwah-ah-nyih
Brother · Sister

Ee · Mba

eh-eh · m-bah
Yes · No

Ana m amụ asụsụ Igbo!

ah-nah m ah-mu ah-su-su ee-gboh
I am learning Igbo!







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

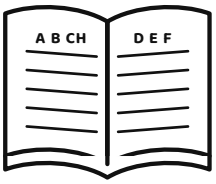
[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

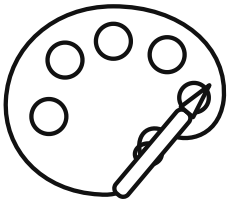
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), rounded.

What's next?
You have met all **36 Igbo letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Igbo, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

Mashallah! I mere nke ọma!

mah-shah-lah! ee meh-reh n-keh aw-mah — Mashallah! You did well!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 36 letters of the Igbo alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author



Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
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